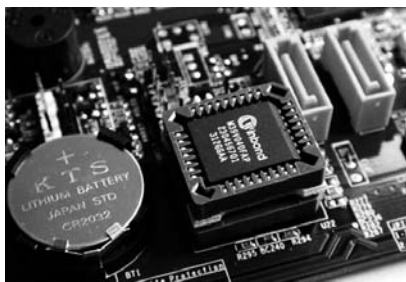


rule to follow here is, “If it ain’t broke, don’t fix it!”.

Identify if your BIOS is flashable

The first step is to identify if you have a flashable BIOS. Peel the sticker off the BIOS chip and note down the



The CMOS chip on a motherboard

model number. Go to the motherboard manufacturer’s Web site and search for the model and whether it’s flashable. Once you’ve determined that you have a flashable BIOS, we are in business.

Note Down The Current Settings

The next step is to note down all the current BIOS settings. Switch on the PC and enter your BIOS setup. If you have a printer attached and the print screen button works, go to each and every menu page and print out the settings. Otherwise, note it down by hand. In case something goes wrong, you will need to refer to these settings to reset your BIOS.

Get the latest BIOS updates

Once you’ve copied down all your settings, the next step is to identify the latest updates for your BIOS. To do this, go to your motherboard manufacturer’s Web site and look up BIOS updates for your motherboard model, make and number. Download the correct update from the site. Download the flash program (usually a .exe file) that will ‘flash’ the update onto your BIOS chip. Usually, the update and the flash program will be zipped together.

Create two MS-DOS boot floppy disks

Ensure that you’re on a reliable power supply and that your floppy drive is not defective. Copy the flash program to a new floppy disk formatted as an MS-DOS startup disk. (Right click the floppy drive and select ‘Format...’; in Windows 98, select the ‘Copy System Files’ checkbox, in Windows XP, select ‘Create an MS-DOS Startup Disk’). Keep a second formatted disk also ready.